

# HC Services — People Code

## Section 3: Probation Policy

### Section 3.0: Document Control

**Document Reference:** HC-PC-003

**Version:** 2.1

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**Owner:** People & Culture Division

| Version | Effective from | Superseded on | What changed                                                                     |
|---------|----------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2.1     | 1 January 2025 | —             | Current version. No clause of this policy has been amended since it took effect. |

### Section 3.1: Policy Scope

This policy applies to every new employee of HC Services and to every employee transferring internally into a materially different role. It governs the probationary period only; performance management after confirmation is dealt with under HC-PC-008.

### Section 3.2: Probationary Period Duration

#### 3.2.1 Standard Period

All new employees serve a probationary period of **6 months** from their official start date, unless their contract specifies otherwise.

#### 3.2.2 Extended Period by Grade

Employees joining at **Grade 7 and above** — the Leadership and Executive bands defined in HC-PC-007 §7.6 — may serve a probationary period of up to **12 months** where their contract states so.

#### 3.2.3 Internal Transfers

An employee transferring internally into a materially different role may serve a reduced probationary period of **3 months**, at the discretion of the receiving department head and People & Culture. Internal transfer does not break continuous service (HC-PC-007 §7.2), so annual leave entitlement under HC-PC-001 §1.2.2 is unaffected.

### Section 3.3: Performance Review During Probation

#### 3.3.1 Review Milestones

Probation is reviewed against fixed milestones. Days are counted from the start date in calendar days:

| Milestone              | Due (standard 6-month) | Form    | Owner                | If missed                                           |
|------------------------|------------------------|---------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Onboarding check-in    | Day 30                 | —       | Line manager         | Escalated to People & Culture                       |
| Mid-probation review   | Day 90                 | HR-P-01 | Line manager         | Probation cannot be extended on performance grounds |
| Confirmation decision  | Day 150                | HR-P-03 | Line manager and P&C | Probation lapses and the employee is confirmed      |
| Written outcome issued | Day 165                | HR-P-03 | People & Culture     | Employee is confirmed by default                    |

Forms are listed in the Forms Register at HC-PC-007 §7.9.

### 3.3.2 Outcomes

A probation review concludes with one of three outcomes: **Confirmed**, where performance meets the requirements of the role at a rating of 3 or above on the scale at HC-PC-007 §7.8; **Extended**, under §3.6; or **Not confirmed**, terminating employment under §3.4.

Confirmation is the event that makes an employee eligible for remote working (HC-PC-004 §4.2.1) and for annual leave to be taken rather than merely accrued (HC-PC-001 §1.1).

## Section 3.4: Notice Period During Probation

The Company may terminate employment during probation by giving **14 calendar days'** written notice, or payment of 14 days' salary in lieu, in accordance with UAE Labour Law. An employee resigning during probation gives the same 14 calendar days' notice.

Note that this is expressed in **calendar** days, unlike the notice periods in HC-PC-001 §1.4.1, which are working days. The distinction is defined at HC-PC-007 §7.3.

## Section 3.5: Benefits During Probation

### 3.5.1 Annual Leave

Annual leave accrues during probation at the standard rate (HC-PC-001 §1.2.2) but may **not be taken** during the first 3 months of service without the express approval of both the line manager and People & Culture. Emergency leave under HC-PC-001 §1.4.3 is not restricted.

### 3.5.2 Sick Leave

Sick leave is available from day one but is paid at half pay throughout probation — see HC-PC-002 §2.2.2. Sick absence exceeding 30 calendar days extends probation under §3.6.1.

### 3.5.3 Medical Insurance

Company medical insurance commences on the start date, without waiting period.

### 3.5.4 Air Ticket Allowance

The annual air ticket allowance commences **on confirmation**, not on the start date, and is not paid in respect of any part of the probationary period. It is not a fixed allowance for the purposes of leave pay — see HC-PC-007 §7.4 and HC-PC-001 §1.6.1.

## Section 3.6: Extension of Probation

### 3.6.1 Grounds for Extension

Probation may be extended once, by up to **3 months**, where performance is short of the requirement but improvement is judged achievable; where the employee has been absent on sick leave for more than **30 calendar days** during probation, in which case the extension is by the number of days absent in excess of 30; or where a mid-probation review under §3.3.1 could not be held for reasons outside the employee's control.

### 3.6.2 Notice of Extension

The line manager must give written notice of extension no later than **10 working days** before the end of the original probationary period, documented on Form HR-P-02. Working days exclude public holidays — see HC-PC-007 §7.3 and the holiday table at HC-PC-001 §1.7. Notice given late is invalid and the employee is confirmed.

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## Section 3.7: Grievances During Probation

An employee may raise a grievance about the conduct of their probation under HC-PC-009 §9.2. Raising a grievance does not pause the probationary period.

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*For queries about this policy, contact People & Culture at [people@hcservices.ae](mailto:people@hcservices.ae) or raise a query via the HCS Concierge.*